

Pain Management Visit Summary and Care Plan

This summary documents the quarterly pain management visit and the ongoing care plan for chronic low back pain. It is provided to the patient for personal records. It is not a prescription. Share only as you choose.

1. Patient and Visit

Patient	John W. Singleton (Jack)
Date of birth	1980-10-15
Occupation	Commercial waterman, owner-operator
Visit type	Quarterly follow-up
Provider	Robert Kessler, MD
Next visit	2026-11-04

2. History

Patient has a herniated L4 to L5 disc diagnosed in 2022 after a winter gear rebuild season. Work involves heavy lifting, pot hauling, and long days standing on a moving deck from April through November. Symptoms are mechanical low back pain with occasional radiation into the left leg, worse with prolonged bending and cold weather. One to two flare episodes per year that limit activity for two to three days.

3. Current Medications

Medication	Dose	Schedule	Purpose
Gabapentin	300 mg	Three times daily	Nerve-related pain
NSAID, as needed	OTC	With food	Flare control
Losartan	50 mg	Each morning	Blood pressure, by Dr. Walsh

4. Examination

Range of motion mildly reduced in forward flexion. Straight leg raise mildly positive on the left at 60 degrees. Strength preserved. Gait normal. Blood pressure 132 over 84, consistent with the reading managed by primary care. No new red flag findings.

5. Assessment

- Chronic mechanical low back pain, stable since last visit.
- Herniated L4 to L5 disc, managed conservatively.
- Occupational load is the primary aggravating factor.
- Medication regimen tolerated, no side effects reported.

6. Care Plan

Continue gabapentin at the current dose. Resume the home physical therapy program, which the patient acknowledges he skips during the busy season. Emphasis on core stabilization, hamstring flexibility, and proper lifting mechanics on the boat. Use the hydraulic pot puller for the heaviest loads rather than manual lifting. Apply heat before early-morning runs in cold weather.

Plan Item	Detail	Frequency
Gabapentin	Continue 300 mg three times daily	Daily
Home PT	Core and hamstring program	Daily, 15 min
Activity	Use puller, avoid manual heavy lift	Every run
Heat	Before cold-morning starts	As needed
Follow-up	Quarterly review	2026-11-04

7. When to Seek Urgent Care

- New weakness or numbness in the legs.
- Loss of bladder or bowel control.
- Severe pain not relieved by rest and medication.
- Fever with back pain.

8. Patient Notes

Patient counseled on pacing during the season and on not working through severe flares. The off-season window, December through March, is the time to rebuild strength before the April opening. Coordination of blood pressure care continues with Dr. Margaret Walsh at Annapolis Internal Medicine.

Prepared for the patient record. Robert Kessler, MD, Cloverdale Health.

Appendix. Home Program Detail

This is the home exercise reference discussed at the visit. Five to fifteen minutes daily, more in the off-season window December through March when there is time to rebuild before the April opening.

Exercise	Reps	Purpose
Pelvic tilt	10, twice	Core activation
Knee to chest	10 each side	Lumbar mobility
Hamstring stretch	30 sec, twice	Reduce strain
Bird dog	8 each side	Stabilization
Wall sit	20 sec, three	Leg strength

Lifting Reminders on the Boat

- Use the hydraulic pot puller for heavy strings.
- Bend the knees, keep the load close, no twisting under load.
- Warm up before the first pull on cold mornings.
- Stop and rest at the first sign of a flare, do not push through.

Coordinate blood pressure care with Dr. Margaret Walsh. Next pain follow-up 2026-11-04.